



# BOOK OF CHANGES - THE ART OF BASIL PAO

**Digital Storytelling  
Proposal**

## MAPPING

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# HERITAGE THEMATIC EXHIBITION - BOOK OF CHANGES: THE ART OF BASIL PAO

## TAI KWUN 大館

Centered Cultural Hub — Designed to bring the **community** together it offers an engaging space for the public to discover and appreciate **art**, **history**, and **culture**.  
Historical Transformation — The former Central Police Station, Central Magistracy, and Victoria Prison  
Championing the Creative Future — A rare, peaceful public gathering space right in the middle of the **Central** district



HERITAGE CONSERVATION

COMMUNITY BETTERMENT

YOUTH SUPPORTMENT



SUPPORTED BY:  
The Hong Kong Jockey Club (HKJC)  
The Hong Kong SAR Government



As a classical divination document and a philosophical exposition, the Yijing, or Book of Changes, is an essential **Chinese cultural heritage**.

The exhibition delves into the classic's symbolic system of **64 hexagrams** and its emphasis on **change**, **harmony**, and **human agency**.

The exhibition aims to bring abstract **philosophical ideas** to life and **inspire reflection** on the relevance of ancient wisdom in today's world.

## EXHIBITION MEDIUMS

- Photography & Montage
- 64 glowing, rectangular lightbox columns
- Moving Image & Video Installation
- Interactive Divination Station



## TARGETED AUDIENCE

- Traditional Culture & Philosophy Enthusiasts
- Photography and Art Lovers
- The General Public & Tourists
- Nature & Environmental Advocates



## POTENTIALS

### 01 Interactivity within "Gamification" — Game

The current divination station—where visitors get a hexagram and a postcard by one click—is a great hook for the general public, but it superficializes the **philosophical experience**.

### 02 Immersion within Photography — Interactive Projection

The 16-minute moving image room currently relies on generic "soothing music" with the aerial nature footage, where audiences simply sit and watch without any **interactions**.

### 03 Philosophy within Texture — Transmedia Performance

The exhibition tries to convey a deeply abstract, ancient philosophy, relying heavily on **texture** which makes audiences simply walk through without absorbing the core message.

# THE MET REPLICA

An innovative, gamified O2O (online-to-offline) program that seamlessly bridges the physical museum experience with the **virtual metaverse** platform, Roblox. Designed primarily to engage tech-savvy youth and **gamify** art education, this initiative effectively transforms traditional museum exploration into an **interactive** digital treasure hunt.



## CHARACTERISTICS

ACCESSIBILITY

It creates a decentralized, social hub where **global audiences** can interact, explore, and showcase their digital collections, establishing a true ecosystem of participatory culture.

ONLINE-TO-OFFLINE

The project turns the traditional museum visit into a **physical treasure hunt**. It uses a mobile app and augmented reality (AR) to guide visitors through physical galleries, blending the concrete reality of the museum with a **digital layer** to boost engagement.

ENGAGEMENT

Scanning a real-world masterpiece rewards the user with a functional, 3D **digital asset** for their inventory, turning cultural education into highly desirable digital **social currency**.

## THE MESSAGE

- Artworks can be easily **accessible**.
- Museum can be **extended** through multi media.
- The traditional museum visit can be a **fun experience**.



## POTENTIALS

### Online to Offline Flow

Users must **physically** walk through the gallery, find a specific painting, and **scan** it to unlock an item. Through a digital game users must have more interest in going into physical exhibition.

### Extension

Scanning real-world art gives users a functional 3D Roblox accessory to customize their **digital identity**. A digital approach can have the potential to enrich user's **social identity** or **personal emotion**.

Media | Interactive Projection



TEAMLAB — STORY OF THE FOREST

TeamLab took 69 original 19th-century 2D brush paintings of **local** flora and fauna and digitally modeled them into **fluid**, three-dimensional animations. Visitors enter a **massive interactive** forest that **shifts** seamlessly from morning to night and **cycles** through Singapore’s wet and dry seasons.



THE MESSAGE

Static and historical artworks can be transferred to **fluid** environment.

Artworks can be an **interactive experience**.

CHARACTERISTICS

MOVING

The 19th-century drawings are not hanging on a wall but **animated** into a living world where visuals never repeat.

ACTIVATED

When visitor stands completely still near a wall, the digital ground opens up, trees grow rapidly, and wildlife **approaches** them.

POTENTIALS

Immersiveness

Artworks that wait to be viewed is transformed into an **immersive surrounding** environment.

Interactivity

Static image becomes real-time, **non-repeating** growing element.

# Media | Transmedia Storytelling

## LETTERS LIVE

Letters Live is a dynamic **event format** that attracted outstanding talents to performing remarkable letters in front of a live audience. Their vision is to harness the power of letters through curated events of exceptional quality and to develop a **multi-media platform** that delivers the most memorable letters to people all around the world.



## CHARACTERISTICS

### HIGH-IMPACT

The event format is incredibly simple. There are no elaborate sets or special effects. It is just a microphone, a spotlight, and a performer. The power comes entirely from the **emotional connection**.

### RESURRECTION

It takes static, private, historical 2D letters and transforms them into living, 3D, public **performances**.

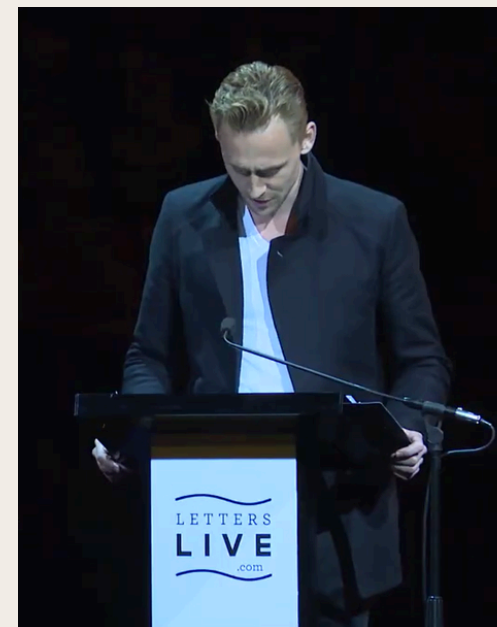
### FLUIDITY

The storytelling spans **multiple media** then lives forever on digital media platforms.

## THE MESSAGE

Historical archives do not need **heavy, flashy technology** to be immersive.

Human **connection** is the key point in transmedia storytelling.



## POTENTIALS

### Performativity

This project demonstrates the physical, emotional act of speaking words aloud can instantly command an audience's **attention**.

### Creation

A single live event generates dozens of modular, highly **shareable digital assets**.

# BOOK OF CHANGES- THE ART OF BASIL PAO

## BACKGROUND

Digital storytelling project: Mapping is a project with online and offline programmes to deliver the theme of the exhibition "BOOK OF CHANGES- THE ART OF BASIL PAO" through **transmedia storytelling**.

## PROGRAMMES

### 1 "Yijing: The Binary Oracle"

Digital Game / Onsite Analysis / Offsite

**Education**

### 2 "The Chamber of Changes"

Interactive Projection / Onsite

**Interactivity**

### 3 "Our Hexagrams"

Transmedia Performance / Onsite Recital / Offsite

**Connection**

## OBJECTIVES & 3 KEYS

To fully **interpret** the exhibition in the philosophy / experience.

**Education**

To enrich the understanding of the philosophy.

**Interactivity**

To enrich the enjoyment of the exhibition.

**Connection**

To expand the public engagement.

# "YIJING: THE BINARY ORACLE"

## Brief

The 64 hexagrams are a primitive, six-digit binary system. By playing the game 'Don't Tap the White Tile', where the user must tap the black tiles (1 / Yang) and avoid the white tiles (0 / Yin), the audience visually translate their inputs into one of the 64 ancient hexagramsis. And they need to navigate the **physical exhibition** space, hunting through the 64 glowing lightbox columns to find their specific analysis.

## Obstacles

Converting online hype into **physical** exhibition visit can be difficult.

## References

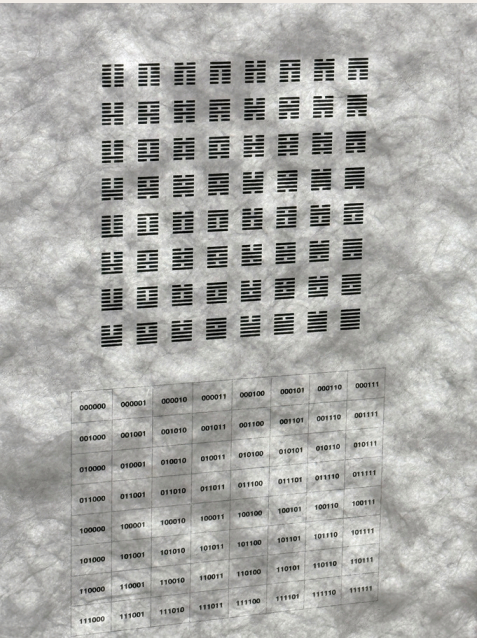
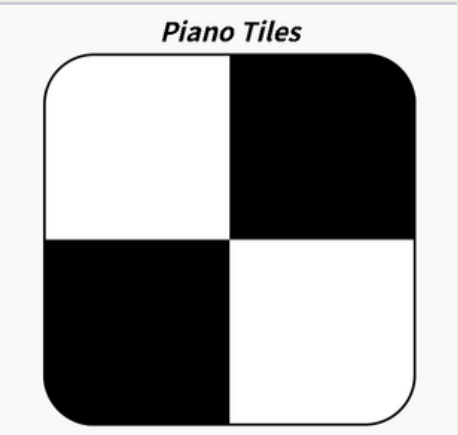
The reference of The Met Replica showcased game directs users back into the **physical architecture** of museum.

## Aims & Objectives

Explaining the abstract philosophy through the **physical act** of inputting a binary code.

Transferring philosophical exercise into a **fun** challenge that appeals to families, students, and tourists.

The "Piano Key" logic (Black=1, White=0) is a **universal** metaphor for binary state that is immediately understood by wide public.



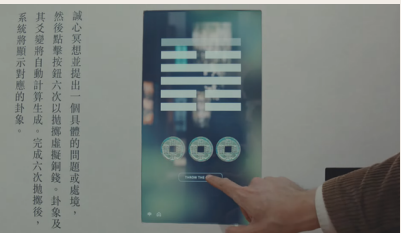
## Experience Flow

### Phase 1: Pre-Exhibition Campaign

Use digital channels to give teaser version of the web game and create early commitment from the public, transforming them from passive scrollers into **invested participants** before they even arrive.

### Phase 2: On-Site Hunt

Upon arriving, visitors transition from passive observers into active explorers, using an intuitive mobile interaction as a personal compass to hunt down their specific artwork within the physical gallery. The journey culminates in a deeply rewarding moment of **self-discovery** and **community connection** as they claim tangible souvenirs and watch their individual destiny illuminate a collective, room-sized digital matrix.



# "THE CHAMBER OF CHANGES"

## Brief

Inside a dark, 360-degree projection-mapped black box room, Basil Pao's static landscape elements are deconstructed and rebuilt into a living, **responsive** digital ecosystem that visualizes the **fluid philosophy** of the Yijing.

## Obstacles - The "Theme Park" Effect

Visitors might flock to the room to play with the interactive walls and take selfies, completely **skipping** or **ignoring** the depth of Basil Pao's actual fine-art photography, reducing a philosophical art exhibition to a tech novelty.

## References

The reference of teamLab's Story of the Forest showcased historical and local asset can be transferred into an **immersive** environment.

The reference from the National Museum of Singapore showcased how people **interact** with an old time city view.

## Aims & Objectives

Bringing static photographs to **life** by projection and sound effects.

Encouraging audience to **participate** rather than sitting and watching.

Transforming the artist's understanding into audience's **first-hand** experience through interactive effects.



from: National Museum of Singapore



## Experience Flow

### Phase 1: The Portal

A short, completely dark, zigzagging corridor leading into the immersive room.

### Phase 2: The Living Matrix

Visitors naturally wander around. As they step on the floor, ripples of binary code (0s and 1s) expand from their footsteps, and the scenery reacts to their presence.

### Phase 3: Co-Creation

When visitors approach the interactive walls, a subtle visual prompt guides them to touch the projection. One touch is one input of "1"

### Phase 4: The Unified Echo

Every 5 minutes, the room undergoes a complete environmental shift called "The Unified Echo." The individual interactions pause, and the system aggregates all the binary inputs generated by the audience over the last block of time to calculate one dominant hexagram for the room.

# "OUR HEXAGRAMS"

## Brief

Crowdsource the **public's real-life stories** of "change" via a digital online archive. These digital submissions are then transformed into embodied, collective experiences through weekly **live recitals** in Tai Kwun's outdoor spaces, physically bridging the gap between ancient philosophy and modern lived realities.

## Obstacles - Editorial Bottlenecks

User-generated content through open call may be off-topic and poorly structured. **Filtering**, curating, and shaping this raw data into a cohesive, theatrical script is necessary.

## References

The reference of Letters Live showcased timeless **emotions**, voice **performativity**, and **archival storytelling** works well in connecting the public.

## Aims & Objectives

**Grounding** the philosophy of "change" in real, relatable life pivots.

Activating Tai Kwun's architecture to the **community**.

Inviting the public to **participate** in and be co-authors of the exhibition's narrative.

## Experience Flow

### Phase 1: The Online Callout

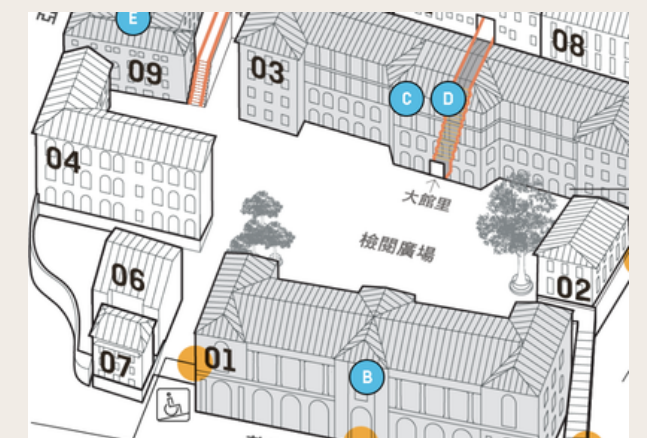
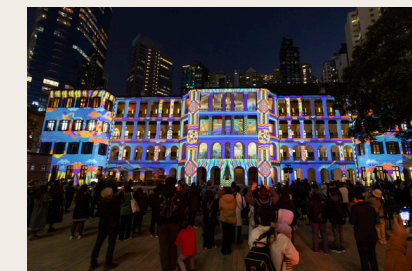
Launch a digital campaign, asking people to submit a short letter or story about a time their life took a dramatic, unexpected turn.

### Phase 2: The Outdoor Event

Every weekend at dusk in Tai Kwun's outdoor courtyard, host a 30-minute minimalist recital. A single microphone, a spotlight, and a reader.

### Phase 3: The In-Gallery Audio Archive

Professional audio recordings of these weekly outdoor readings are uploaded directly into the exhibition's mobile WebApp. Museum visitors can tap their phone to listen to the recording of the real Hong Kong citizen's letter that was performed that week.



# REFLECTION

## on Media

Designing this proposal completely reshaped my understanding of what "media" can be. Initially, when tasked with bringing an ancient, abstract text like the Yijing to life, the default instinct was to rely on screens—to build a better hermeneutic technology where the audience simply reads the philosophy in a more interactive way.

However, this process taught me that the future of media is not about trapping people in digital interfaces; it is about spatial and embodied performativity. By breaking the proposal into three tiers—the O2O hunt, the reactive Chamber of Changes, and the outdoor live recitals—I realized that true transmedia storytelling treats the human body as the **ultimate medium**. The digital layer only succeeds when it pushes the user back into **physical reality**: forcing them to look closely at Basil Pao's physical photography, to stand still in a dark room, or to gather face-to-face in a Tai Kwun courtyard to listen to a stranger's voice.

Looking forward, as the boundaries between our physical lives and digital ecosystems (like the decentralized web and spatial computing) continue to blur, my goal is to design media that facilitates this exact kind of seamless crossover. Technology should not isolate us; it should act as a catalyst that makes our physical spaces and **offline human connections** more profound and legible.

## on Research

On a research level, this project was a masterclass in synthesis and **problem-solving**. My early research felt fragmented—I was looking at The Met Replica for gamification, teamLab for immersion, and Letters Live for community. The breakthrough happened when I stopped looking at what these case studies built, and started researching why they worked. I had to deconstruct the psychology behind them: why people crave digital social currency, why stillness unlocks awe, and why vulnerability in public speaking builds immediate community.

And this even brought my own museum visiting experience in Singapore as a reference. This project proved to me that research is not just about gathering data or applying sociological theories; it is an iterative act of translation. Moving forward in my career, I want to continue this methodology: taking dense, complex systems—whether ancient philosophies or emerging digital frameworks—and translating them into intuitive, deeply **human experiences**.

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# REFERENCE

- 1 Participatory Culture-Henry Jenkins
  - 2 The Met Replica
  - 3 teamLab — Story of the Forest
  - 4 Letters Live
  - 5 Transmedia Storytelling-Henry Jenkins
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